# Masha Kuritsyn

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## EDUCATION

**UC San Diego** Expected June 2029
*B.S. Cognitive Science, Spec. Machine Learning and Neural Computation* *GPA: 3.98/4.00*

## EXPERIENCE

**Intern** | UCSD Design Lab Sep 2026 – Present
- Selected for the Design Lab's Junior Designer program, practicing applied human-centered design through mentored, real-world projects.

**Product Design Intern** | Kitchens for Good Jul – Sep 2026
- Co-designed environmental branding and a mural concept for a San Diego nonprofit on a 4-person design team.
- Kept the mural consistent with the concurrent website redesign by working within its typography, logo usage, and color system.
- Presented work to the nonprofit's representative weekly, turning stakeholder feedback into revised design directions across multiple rounds.

**Research Assistant** | Visual Learning Lab, UC San Diego Mar 2026 – Present
- Redesign the lab's Baby Science outreach and shape its content strategy to make developmental research accessible to families (@ucsdbabysci).
- Built a Python preprocessing pipeline for a gaze-attention study, using Qwen3.5 with structured-output constraints to generate standardized scene descriptions from video frames, grounded in meaning-map methodology.
- Integrated Meta AI's SAM with DataVyu into a scalable pipeline for analyzing visual attention across video stimuli.
- Run developmental movie-watching experiments with child and adult participants under Dr. Bria Long and Dr. AJ Haskins.

## PROJECTS

**SolSpace** | UI/UX Designer & Front-End Developer, ACM at UCSD Apr – Jun 2026
- Designed a mobile app that helps UCSD students discover campus events and feel less isolated, with a team of 3 designers.
- Conducted 14 user interviews and turned insights into wireframes and high-fidelity Figma screens, then coded the front end; shipped a working prototype on Vercel and presented at the ACM Spring Projects Showcase.

**Habitat for Humanity** | UX Researcher, World Studios Sep – Dec 2025
- Led UX research for a 10-week redesign of Habitat for Humanity's website to streamline its volunteering process, running surveys, 15 user interviews, and 10 usability tests.

**Mylo** | UI/UX Designer, FigBuild by Figma Mar 2026
- Co-designed a speculative wellness app that shows neuroplasticity as a growing "neural fingerprint," coordinating 3 designers and a developer over a 3-day hackathon.
- Prototyped in Figma Make, working with AI-generated UI components and designing around their limits.

**Dancers' Injury & Mental Health Study** | Independent Researcher Published
- Designed and published an IRB-approved study on injury severity, mental health, and coping among Bay Area ballet dancers, mentored by a USC PhD candidate.
- Analyzed survey data in R, finding strong associations between injury and anxiety, perfectionism, and body-image concerns.

## LEADERSHIP & INVOLVEMENT

**Notion Campus Leader** | Represent Notion at UCSD, growing a student community and helping peers set up Notion for their classes and projects.
**Member** | DesignCo, World Studios (IDEA Program), Triton Neuronetwork, Out the Archive

## SKILLS

**Skills:** User Research, Usability Testing, A/B Testing, Competitive Analysis, Wireframing, Prototyping, Visual Design, Design Systems, Branding, Stakeholder Communication, Data Analysis
**Tools:** Figma, Figma Make, Framer, Adobe Creative Suite, Procreate, Canva, Notion, Vercel, Cursor, Claude, Datavyu, Meta SAM, Qwen
**Languages:** HTML/CSS, JavaScript, React, Python, R, Java